

C Preprocessor

If you're careful, it's possible (and can be useful) to use `#include` within a header file, so that you end up with ``nested header files."

It's possible to use `#define` to define ``function-like" macros that accept arguments; the expansion of the macro can therefore depend on the arguments it's ``invoked" with.

Two special preprocessing operators `#` and `##` let you control the expansion of macro arguments in fancier ways.

The preprocessor directive `#if` lets you conditionally include (or, with `#else`, conditionally not include) a section of code depending on some arbitrary compile-time expression. (`#if` can also do the same macro-definedness tests as `#ifdef` and `#ifndef`, because the expression can use a `defined` `()` operator.)

Other preprocessing directives are `#elif`, `#error`, `#line`, and `#pragma`.

There are a few predefined preprocessor macros, some required by the C standard, others perhaps defined by particular compilation environments. These are useful for conditional compilation (`#ifdef`, `#ifndef`).

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